



9 study destinations compared: cost, life, work and degree recognition

One table instead of ten websites — with official university prices and the year they belong to

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All prices below come from official university price lists, with the year stated. Universities publish 2027/28 prices closer to intake, so treat these as ranges, not quotes.

Tuition and living cost

Destination	Tuition	Living
Türkiye	from \$500 a year at public, from \$4,000 at private universities (2025/26)	from \$700 a month (Istanbul)
UAE	about AED 60,000–80,000 a year at branch campuses (2026/27)	from AED 5,500 a month (Dubai)
Malaysia	about RM 35,000–45,000 a year at private universities (2026)	from RM 2,000 a month (Kuala Lumpur)
Italy	from €160 a year at public universities, income-based (ISEE), 2026/27	about €1,100–1,400 a month in Milan
Spain	about €1,200–8,200 a year at public universities; private cost more (2026/27)	from €600 a month (IPREM legal minimum: €7,200 a year)
Hungary	about €6,000–10,000 a year in English (2025/26–2026/27)	about €800–1,300 a month (Budapest)
Georgia	MD in English: \$5,900–6,500 at private, \$8,000 at public universities (2026/27)	about GEL 1,730 a month without rent (Tbilisi, Numbeo)
North Cyprus	\$4,450–6,400 a year at EMU (public); €2,800–4,500 at private universities after the standard discount (2026/27)	depends on the university: campus housing is published per year in USD
Cyprus	about €9,000–11,820 a year at private universities; medicine €23,000–24,000 (2026/27)	rent €600–1,000 plus €600–900 a month for other costs

Language, entry and work

Destination	Language of study	Entry and status	Work while studying
Türkiye	English and Turkish	student visa, then a student residence permit (ikamet)	only with a work permit (çalışma izni)
UAE	English	student visa sponsored by the university	limited, only through approved schemes
Malaysia	English	Student Pass through EMGS, approved before you travel	up to 20 hours a week during breaks, with approval
Italy	Italian and English	type D visa via University, then a residence permit	up to 20 hours a week and 1,040 hours a year
Spain	Spanish; some programmes in English	student visa, then a TIE card	up to 30 hours a week, no separate permit needed
Hungary	English; Hungarian is needed for clinical work	type D visa, then a residence permit	up to 30 hours a week; full time during breaks, max 90 days a year
Georgia	English	visa-free entry for many countries, then a student residence permit	depends on your status
North Cyprus	English	TRNC student residence permit	check with your university
Cyprus	English	entry permit applied for by the university	up to 20 hours a week in term time, 38 during breaks, in permitted sectors

Degree recognition — read before you pay

Destination	What matters
Türkiye	YÖK-accredited universities; recognition depends on your home country
UAE	at branch campuses the degree is awarded by the UK or Australian home campus
Malaysia	MQA accreditation; check recognition in your home country
Italy, Spain, Hungary, Cyprus	EU degree
Georgia	NCEQE accreditation, WFME-recognised until 11.2028; Georgian is required to practise medicine
North Cyprus	the TRNC is recognised only by Türkiye. Degrees are not recognised in Europe directly. The working route: a YÖK-listed programme and legalisation of the degree through Turkish authorities

Most agencies stay quiet about North Cyprus. We say it plainly: it is the most affordable English-taught start with easy entry — and it carries a recognition limit you should know about before the first payment.

Medicine taught in English

Available: Türkiye, Georgia, Hungary, Italy, Malaysia, Cyprus, North Cyprus. Not at our partner universities in Spain — medicine there is taught in Spanish.

Next step. Send us your school certificate and your yearly budget. We will shortlist three or four programmes across destinations and tell you honestly where your chances are strongest. The first consultation is free. AcademGo office: Warsaw, ul. Złota 7/28.

Free AcademGo consultation: we shortlist 3–4 programmes within your budget

AcademGo — study abroad consultancy. All figures come from official university and government sources; check the year of the price list before you pay.